

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, key of E-flat major (three flats), and 2/2 time. The melody is characterized by a mix of 2/2 and 3/2 measures, creating an irregular feel. Fingerings are indicated by numbers 1-4, and breath marks (x) are placed above certain notes. Chord diagrams are provided above the staff at various points, showing fingerings for the left hand. The lyrics are written below the staff, with some words hyphenated across measures. The score concludes with a double bar line and the instruction 'D.C.' (Da Capo).

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...